

EBOOK

Chess Fundamentals for Beginners

A complete guide covering everything from piece movement to basic strategy

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Chapter 1: The Chess Board

Chess is played on a board of 64 squares arranged in an 8x8 grid. The squares alternate between light and dark colors. The board is set up so that each player has a light square in the bottom-right corner.

The Starting Position



Coordinates

Every square has a unique coordinate: a letter (a-h for files/columns) and a number (1-8 for ranks/rows). For example, e4 is the intersection of the e-file and the 4th rank. This system is called algebraic notation.

Ø=Ü; TIP: Remember: "Queen on her color" — the White Queen starts on a light square (d1), the Black Queen on a dark square (d8).

Chapter 2: The Pieces and How They Move

The Pawn (&Y) — Value: 1 point

Pawns move forward one square at a time, but capture diagonally. On their first move, they can advance two squares. When a pawn reaches the opposite end of the board, it promotes to any other piece (usually a Queen).

- Moves forward one square (two on first move)

- Captures one square diagonally forward

- Special moves: en passant, promotion

- Cannot move backward

The Knight (&X) — Value: 3 points

The Knight moves in an L-shape: two squares in one direction and one square perpendicular. It is the only piece that can jump over other pieces.

- Moves in an L-shape (2+1 squares)

- Can jump over other pieces

- Always lands on opposite color square

- Most powerful in the center of the board

The Bishop (&W) — Value: 3 points

The Bishop moves diagonally any number of squares. Each Bishop is restricted to one color for the entire game — one on light squares, one on dark squares.

The Rook (&V) — Value: 5 points

The Rook moves horizontally or vertically any number of squares. Rooks are most powerful on open files (columns with no pawns).

The Queen (&U) — Value: 9 points

The Queen combines the power of the Rook and Bishop. She can move any number of squares horizontally, vertically, or diagonally. The most powerful piece on the board.

The King (&T) — Value: Priceless!

The King moves one square in any direction. If your King is checkmated, you lose the game. Protect your King at all costs!

Chapter 3: Special Moves

Castling

Castling is a special move involving the King and a Rook. The King moves two squares toward the Rook, and the Rook jumps over the King. This is the only move where two pieces move at once.

Kingside castling (O-O): King goes to g1/g8, Rook to f1/f8

Queenside castling (O-O-O): King goes to c1/c8, Rook to d1/d8

Neither piece can have moved before

No pieces between King and Rook

King cannot castle out of, through, or into check

En Passant

When a pawn advances two squares from its starting position and lands beside an enemy pawn, the opponent can capture it "in passing" as if it had only moved one square. This must be done immediately on the next move.

Pawn Promotion

When a pawn reaches the far end of the board (rank 8 for White, rank 1 for Black), it must be promoted to a Queen, Rook, Bishop, or Knight. Most players choose a Queen.

Chapter 4: Check, Checkmate, and Draws

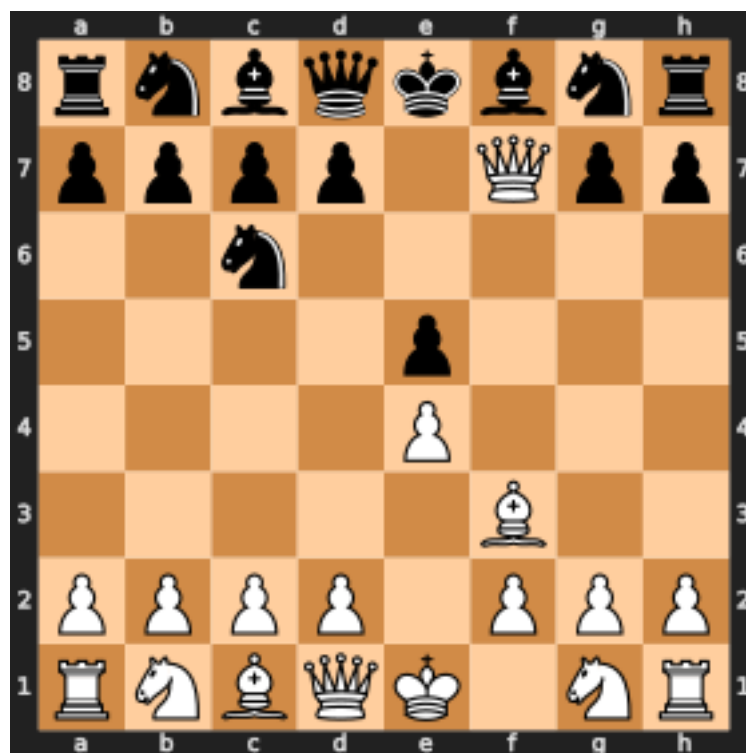
Check

When a piece attacks the enemy King, the King is "in check." The player must immediately get out of check by: moving the King, blocking the check, or capturing the attacking piece.

Checkmate

When a King is in check and there is no way to escape, it is "checkmate" — the game is over! The player who delivers checkmate wins.

Scholar's Mate — A common checkmate for beginners



Types of Draws

Stalemate: The player to move has no legal moves but is NOT in check

Insufficient material: Neither side has enough pieces to checkmate

Threefold repetition: Same position occurs three times

Fifty-move rule: 50 moves without a capture or pawn move

Agreement: Both players agree to draw

Chapter 5: Basic Opening Principles

The opening is the first phase of the game. Follow these principles to start your games well:

- Control the center (e4, d4, e5, d5)
- Develop your pieces (Knights and Bishops first)
- Castle early to protect your King
- Don't move the same piece twice without reason
- Don't bring the Queen out too early
- Connect your Rooks by developing all minor pieces

Ø=Üj TIP: A good opening sequence for White: 1.e4, develop Knights to f3 and c3, develop Bishops, castle, then connect Rooks.

Chapter 6: Tactical Motifs

Forks

A fork is when one piece attacks two or more enemy pieces at the same time. Knight forks are the most common and devastating.

Pins

A pin is when a piece is attacked but cannot move because it would expose a more valuable piece behind it. An absolute pin involves the King.

Skewers

A skewer is the opposite of a pin — a more valuable piece is attacked and must move, exposing a less valuable piece behind it.

Discovered Attacks

A discovered attack happens when one piece moves, revealing an attack from the piece behind it. Discovered checks are especially powerful.

Chapter 7: Endgame Essentials

The endgame begins when most pieces have been traded. Key concepts:

- 1. Activate your King — in the endgame, the King becomes a fighting piece
- 2. Create passed pawns — pawns with no opposing pawns blocking them
- 3. Learn basic checkmates: King + Queen vs King, King + Rook vs King
- 4. Opposition: Kings facing each other with one square between them
- 5. The Rule of the Square: Can the King catch a passed pawn?

Chapter 8: Your First Games

Now that you know the rules and basic strategy, here are tips for your first games:

- Play slowly and think before each move
- Ask yourself: "Is my move safe? Can my opponent capture something?"
- Look for checks, captures, and threats on every move
- Don't worry about memorizing openings — focus on principles
- Analyze your games afterward to learn from mistakes
- Have fun! Every grandmaster was once a beginner.

Ø=Üj TIP: Play online at lichess.org (free!) or chess.com. Start with longer time controls (10+0 or 15+10) so you have time to think.

Congratulations on completing Chess Fundamentals for Beginners! Keep practicing, study tactics daily, and enjoy your chess journey.